MIL-N-36688B(DSA-DM)
21 June 1976
SUPERSEDING
MIL-N-36688A
16 July 1974

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

NORETHINDRONE ACETATE AND ETHINYL ESTRADIOL TABLETS, USP

This specification is approved for use by the Defense Personnel Support Center, Defense Supply Agency, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers Norethindrone Acetate and Ethinyl Estradiol Tablets, USP.

1.2 Classification. The tablets covered by this specification shall be of the following sizes and strengths (See 6.2):

Size 1 - 63s
Size 2 - 140s
Strength 1 - 1.0 mg Norethindrone Acetate and 0.05 mg Ethinyl Estradiol.
Strength 2 - 1.5 mg Norethindrone Acetate and 0.03 mg Ethinyl Estradiol.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Hq, Defense Personnel Support Center, ATTN: Directorate of Medical Materiel, DPSC-ATT, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document, or by letter.

FSC 6505

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T09:08Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Issues of documents. The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Setup.
PPP-C-186 - Containers, Packaging and Packing for Drugs, Chemicals, and Pharmaceuticals. (See 6.3)

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-140 - Tablets (for Medicinal Purposes).

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of specification and standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals shall apply.

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH, EDUCATION, AND WELFARE,
FOOD AND DRUG ADMINISTRATION

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Food and Drug Administration, Washington, DC 20204.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T09:08Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

U. S. PHARMACOPEIAL CONVENTION, INC.

The United States Pharmacopeia.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Mack Publishing Company, Easton, PA 18042.)

National Formulary.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Mack Publishing Company, Easton, PA 18042.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. Shall be Norethindrone Acetate and Ethinyl Estradiol Tablets, USP, and shall be in accordance with all applicable requirements of FED-STD-140, and as specified herein:

S2. Classification. Shall be type I.

S5.2 The following is added to this paragraph:

Strength 1 shall be tablets containing 1.0 mg of Norethindrone Acetate and 0.05 mg Ethinyl Estradiol per tablet, within the applicable assay limits for the tablets.

Strength 2 shall be tablets containing 1.5 mg of Norethindrone Acetate and 0.03 mg Ethinyl Estradiol per tablet, within the applicable assay limits for the tablets.

3.2 Ingredients.

3.2.1 Norethindrone acetate. The norethindrone acetate used in the manufacture of the tablets shall comply with the tests, standards, and requirements of the USP, including any supplements or revisions thereto.

3.2.2 Ethinyl estradiol. The ethinyl estradiol used in the manufacture of the tablets shall comply with the tests, standards, and requirements of the USP, including any supplements or revisions thereto.

3.3 Other ingredients. All other ingredients used in the manufacture of the tablets shall comply with S5.1 of FED-STD-140.

3.4 Expiration dating period. For size 1, strength 1, the expiration dating period shall be 60 months, and for size 2, strength 2, the expiration dating period shall be not less than 48 months.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T09:08Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Supplier responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and, (i) as to any expiration dated item, for the expiration dating period specified by the contractor for such item, or such longer period as may be required by regulation of any federal agency; or (ii) as to non-dated items, for not less than 3 years after delivery of the item to the Government.

4.1.2 No company supplying any ingredient(s) to the contractor will be considered an acceptable facility for the performance of any inspection requirements specified herein.

4.2 Sampling. The sampling as shown in FED-STD-140 shall be applicable.

4.3 Tests and examinations. Tests and examinations shall be performed to determine compliance with all requirements of the document and all referenced documents.

4.4 Packaging inspection. The inspection of the intermediate package, packing and marking for shipment and storage shall be in accordance with quality assurance provisions of the applicable container specification and the marking requirements of MIL-STD-129.

4.5 Labeling inspection. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and the unit of product shall be the unit of issue. The inspection lot shall be the number of units of issue of each batch, lot, control number, etc., offered for inspection at one time. The inspection level for labeling shall be S-2 and the acceptance number shall be zero.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T09:08Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging requirements. The requirements for packaging shall be in accordance with all applicable requirements of PPP-C-186 (See 6.3) and as specified herein.

5.2 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C, as specified (See 6.1).

5.2.1 Unit of issue.

5.2.1.1 Size 1. One box containing one plastic case with 21 tablets and two refills each containing 21 tablets, as specified, constitutes one unit of issue.

5.2.1.2 Size 2. One box containing five plastic cases, with each case containing 28 tablets (21 contraceptive and 7 inert tablets) in individual blisters per laminated sheet, as specified, constitutes one unit of issue.

5.2.2 Level A.

5.2.2.1 Immediate container: Size 1 and size 2. The immediate container for size 1 and size 2 shall be a commercially available laminated sheet with individual blisters for each tablet. Each laminated sheet shall be in, or shall be suitable for insertion into, a plastic case. The bottom of each plastic case shall contain circular holes through which the blistered tablets may be pushed The immediate containers for size 1 and size 2 shall be considered acceptable by the Food and Drug Administration (FDA) for the product contained therein and shall be of such compatibility that neither the contents nor the container are altered in any way by each other.

5.2.2.2 Unit package. Each unit of issue of the size and strength specified shall be packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-566 or PPP-B-676. Closure shall be as specified in the applicable box specification.

5.2.2.3 Intermediate package. Twelve unit packages of one size and strength only shall be packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-636, class domestic or PPP-B-676. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. Units shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind commonly used, which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the product for its intended purpose.

5.3 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C, as specified (See 6.1).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T09:08Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.3.1 Level A. Twenty-four intermediate packages (288 units) containing size 1, strength 1, or six intermediate packages (72 units) containing size 2, strength 2, shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and conforming to PPP-B-636 class weather-resistant. Closure strapping and water-proofing shall be as specified in the appendix of the box specification.

5.3.2 Level B. Twenty-four intermediate packages (288 units) containing size 1, strength 1, or six intermediate packages (72 units) containing size 2, strength 2, shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the box specification.

5.3.3 Level C. The subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commerical containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.4 Marking.

5.4.1 Labeling. Labeling shall be in accordance with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, and shall include the information required below:

5.4.1.1 Immediate container. Each immediate container for size 1 and size 2 shall bear the following information:

(a) label information in accordance with commercial practice.

5.4.1.2 Unit packages. Each unit package label for size 1 and size 2 shall bear the following information:

(a) label information in accordance with commercial practice.

(b) the National Stock Number.

(c) the expiration date.

NOTES: The National Stock Number shall not be preceded by any prefix.

Strip labeling may be used.

Label adhesion test shall apply.

5.4.2 Intermediate package. Intermediate package shall be marked as specified in 5.5.3 of PPP-C-186. Type I Shelf life markings as specified MIL-STD-129 shall be shown. Marking shall include the legend:
"STORE AT CONTROLLED ROOM TEMPERATURE 15° - 30°C (59° - 86°F)".

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T09:08Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.4.3 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be marked as specified in 5.5.4 of PPP-C-186. Type I Shelf life marking as specified in MIL-STD-129 shall be shown. Marking shall include the legend: "STORE AT CONTROLLED ROOM TEMPERATURE 15° - 30°C(59° - 86° F)".

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Number and date of this specification.
(b) the National Stock Number.
(c) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (See 5.3 and 5.4).

6.2 This specification covers the following item(s):

National Stock NUmber	Item Identification	Specification Designation
6505-00-455-9957	NORETHINDRONE ACETATE AND ETHINYL ESTRADIOL TABLETS, USP, 63s	Size 1, Strength 1
6505-01-020-2684	NORETHINDRONE ACETATE AND ETHINYL ESTRADIOL TABLETS, USP, 140s	Size 2, Strength 2

6.3 All references to PPP-C-186 refer to Interim Federal Specification PPP-C-00186B which is mandatory for use until superseded by a revision.

Preparing activity:
Defense Supply Agency - DM

Project No. 6505 - 1739

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T09:08Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

OMB Approval
No. 22-R255

INSTRUCTIONS: The purpose of this form is to solicit beneficial comments which will help achieve procurement of suitable products at reasonable cost and minimum delay, or will otherwise enhance use of the document. DoD contractors, government activities, or manufacturers/ vendors who are prospective suppliers of the product are invited to submit comments to the government. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements. Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity.

DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE
MIL-N-36688B(DSA-DM) NORETHINDRONE ACETATE AND ETHINYL ESTRADIOL TABLETS, USP

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and address - Optional)*

TELEPHONE NO.

DATE

DD FORM 1 JAN 72 1426

REPLACES EDITION OF 1 JAN 66 WHICH MAY BE USED

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T09:08Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.